

1. Content Strategy Memo

MEMORANDUM

- **To:** Content Acquisition & Programming Committee
- **From:** Data Analytics Team
- **Date:** September 24, 2026
- **Subject:** Strategic Content Acquisition Framework (Catalog Trend Insights)

Executive Summary

Analysis of catalog distribution, lifespan metrics, and international maturity segmentation indicates that traditional volume licensing is yielding diminishing returns. To optimize acquisition expenditure and improve subscriber retention, future content licensing should follow three strategic directives:

1. Pivot from Standalone Feature Films to Serialized Television

- **Data Evidence:** While movies comprise ~70% of total lifetime additions, time-series tracking shows movie licensing has contracted sharply since 2019. By 2021, TV show additions matched movie acquisitions.
- **Acquisition Action:** Reallocate 25% of the film acquisition budget toward co-producing multi-episode limited series. Serialized episodic content provides sustained engagement across billing cycles, whereas standalone movies exhibit sharp, one-time viewing drop-offs.

2. Standardize a 90–100 Minute Ceiling for Commissioned Films

- **Data Evidence:** Film runtimes exhibit a normal distribution with a peak at 94–102 minutes. Long-form titles (>130 minutes) make up a negligible fraction of the catalog.
- **Acquisition Action:** Enforce runtime clauses in production contracts capping standard film pitches at 100 minutes. Tighter editing cycles lower post-production costs and increase per-viewer completion rates, boosting recommendation algorithm rankings.

3. Implement Strict Single-Season Renewal Gates & Expand TV-14 in India

- **Data Evidence:** Over 65% of all TV shows conclude after Season 1, with fewer than 10% securing a Season 3 renewal. Concurrently, market segmentation confirms India's catalog is dominated by TV-14 programming (over 550 titles), unlike Western markets where TV-MA dominates.
- **Acquisition Action:** Greenlight TV series with self-contained, single-season story arcs to mitigate subscriber churn from unrenewed cliffhangers. For the Indian market, prioritize mid-budget, high-concept TV-14 family dramas over expensive TV-MA productions to align with existing regional viewing patterns.